

■ ■ ELA Mission Pack — Answer Key & Scoring

For the scorer · Total 50 pts + observed fluency · When torn between two scores, take the lower and note why.

■ ■ Mission 1 — Newsroom Fix-Up (12)

1A · Fix errors (5) — 1 pt per correct fix, any 5 of:

Wrong	Fix	Type
" the octopus might..."	The	Capitalization
"the most amazing thing is it's brain"	its	its vs it's
"each of it's eight arms"	its	its vs it's
"make choices on it's own"	its	its vs it's
"disguise they can change..."	"disguise. They ..." (split run-on)	Run-on
"recognize individual humans faces"	human faces	Adjective vs plural

1B · Sentence that doesn't belong (3): "The fastest land animal is the cheetah." — off-topic, breaks the article's focus. 3 = finds + explains; 2 = finds, thin why; 1 = senses something off; 0 = misses.

1C · Headline (2): accurate + catchy (e.g., "*Nine Brains, Three Hearts: Meet the Ocean's Genius*"). 2 = both; 1 = flat or slightly off; 0 = missing.

1D · Stronger words (2): 1 pt each precise swap. E.g., amazing→astonishing, strangest→most bizarre, tiny→miniature, experts→masters.

■ ■ Mission 2 — Story Reviewer (13)

2A rating + hook — **warm-up, not scored.**

2B · Theme + turning point w/ evidence (7):

Theme (3): courage = acting *despite* fear; strength comes from connection/love, not perfection. (Accept supported variations.)

Turning point + 2 quotes (4): the moment she "**looked up**" and found Arun → chooses to play. 2 pts correct turning point + 1 pt per accurate quote (e.g., "*she looked up,*" "*the exit sign glowed red and kind,*" "*voice cracked ... like ice on a pond*").

2C · Figurative language (2): example + its effect. E.g., "microphone waited like an open mouth" (simile, threatening); "her fingers turned to strangers" (metaphor, lost control). 2 = example+effect; 1 = example only.

2D · Recommendation (3): 3 = names who + convincing why tied to story; 2 = generic reason; 1 = "it's good"; 0 = none.

■ Mission 3 — The Case File (11)

3A · Solve it (4): The **loose hamster (Nibbles)** wrecked/ate the model — **no human thief**. Window locked + only other key-holder out of town rule out people; the open cage latch, quiet "guilty" hamster, empty water bottle, and the reddish "lava" ring + cracker crumb point to Nibbles. 4 = lands on hamster w/ reasoning; 3 = right, thin; 2 = rules out humans only; 1 = guess. *Accept any solution that fits ALL clues — reward reasoning.*

3B · Cite clues (3): 1 pt each — (a) locked window + key-holder away = no human entry; (b) open latch + quiet hamster + empty bottle = Nibbles loose; (c) reddish ring + crumb = model disturbed at the scene.

3C · Words in context (4): **confirmed** = proven true/backed up (clue: "by three relatives"). **secured** = fastened/locked shut (clue: contrast "hung open," "normally"). 2 each = meaning + how he knew; 1 = meaning only.

■ Mission 4 — Make Your Case (14)

4A plan — not scored (glance: did he plan before writing?).

Strand	Pts	Full credit
Informational synthesis	6	Accurate facts from both sheets — 3 for Sheet A (sleep/focus), 3 for Sheet B (bus cost/later dismissal), esp. if he addresses the opposing fact.
Writing quality	7	Clear position (2) · organized claim→reasons→close (2) · persuasive, handles other side (2) · strong closing line (1).
Conventions (real writing)	2	2 = clean sentences/punctuation; 1 = readable w/ slips; 0 = hard to follow.

Why it matters: forcing him to use "even the fact that argues against you" measures **synthesis & counter-argument** — a Grade 5–6 stretch skill. Reward it.

■ Observed — Fluency & Stamina (not in the 50)

Have him read one paragraph aloud. Note rate, expression, and whether focus held through the longer Mission 4 sheets. Rate **1–4** (×25 → %).

■ Score Sheet → Domain Profile

Domain	His pts	Max	% Mastery
Reading — Inference & Evidence	1E, 2E(turn), 3A, 3E	14	
Writing — Constructed Response	1C, 2D, 4E(writing)	12	
Vocabulary & Word Study	1D, 2C, 3C	8	
Conventions	1A, 4E(conv)	7	
Reading — Informational	4E(synthesis)	6	
Reading — Literature	2E(theme)	3	
Fluency & Stamina	observed 1–4	—	
TOTAL		50	

Bands: 90–100% strength (maintain) · 70–89% solid (polish) · 50–69% developing (focus) · <50% priority gap (front-load).

Priority: PriorityScore = (100% – Mastery%) × domain weight (file 01). Sort highest first → hand to the study-plan agent (file 05).

Honest coverage note: performance tasks load inference/writing/synthesis (Thomas's top growth areas — the point). Literature & conventions get fewer points here; if you want a cleaner read on those, add a second reviewer + editor mission on the re-test.